



CHEYENNE DOWNTOWN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

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Cheyenne, WY 82001
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cheyennecity.org/dda

To: Honorable Mayor and members of the City Council

From: Charles W. Bloom, Planning and Development Director

Date: February 21, 2025

Subject: DDA Plan of Development Update

BACKGROUND:

This memorandum summarizes recent actions regarding the Plan of Development and seeks to answer questions and provide clarity based on comments received since the public hearing.

On February 10, 2025, a public hearing was held. At the public hearing several questions and comments were raised by citizens and councilmembers. Those questions are answered in this memorandum. On February 18, 2025, the plan was further discussed at the Public Services Committee (PSC) meeting. DDA board members Roybal, Belotti (Walters), Bau and Volk and staff and Cameron Gloss with Logan Simpson were present.

This memorandum addresses unanswered public hearing comments and questions, changes authorized by DDA and Planning Commission motion, and a proposed substitution based on councilmember comments.

RESPONSE TO PUBLIC HEARING COMMENTS AND QUESTIONS:

Below is a summary of comments made at the Governing Body public hearing on February 10, 2025, followed by a section showing the edits based on the DDA Board and Planning Commission's recommendations on January 21, 2025.

Aldrich: Question about sidewalk repair and CIG grants.

Answer: CIG and FIP grants are summarized on page 64 of the plan. Perhaps an addition to the implementation table for "Continuation of Grant Programs" and "Enhance Walkability" is warranted (Note: These are incorporated in the substitute).

Aldrich: Question about surveying the property owners in the district to see if they are aligned with the plan. How many businesses contacts are you having with business and property owners per month?

Answer: This information is challenging to clearly identify. It is estimated that 10-25 property owners were directly contacted monthly by DDA staff as part of day-to-day activities or requests for information. Document drafts were shared with the DDA Board, Planning Commission, Governing Body, people who had signed up for project alerts on the DDA Plan Update webpage, and partners like the Downtown Business Collective.

Emmons: Question about attendance at all meetings.

Answer:

In-Person events:

- December 2023 Joint Work Session – 11
- January 2024 Business and Property Owner Meeting – 17
- April 2024 Visioning Events: 48 people (sign-in sheet)
- June 2024 Choices Events: 200+ attendees across the 3 days (no sign-ins from the booth drop-ins)
- Draft Plan Events (sign-in sheet) – Property Owners - 28; Public – 30

Questionnaires:

- Q1| Challenges and Opp (Phase 1) – 351 responses
 - 125 responses noted they own property in DT
- Q2| Visioning – 410 responses
 - 148 responses noted they own property in DT

Eblasts

Email Contents	↕↑	Campaign	↕↑	↕↑	↕↑	↕↑	↕↑	↕↑
LAST CHANCE: Review and Comment on the Draft Cheyenne DDA Plan of Development!	...	LAST CHANCE: Review and Comment on the Draft Cheyenne DDA Plan of Development!	0	331	48.94%	10.57%		Dec 4
Review and Comment on the Draft Cheyenne DDA Plan of Development!	...	Review and Comment on the Draft Cheyenne DDA Plan of Development!	0	250	54.00%	20.00%		11/06/2024
Cheyenne DDA Draft Plan Open Houses!	...	Cheyenne DDA Draft Plan Events!	0	249	52.21%	0.40%		10/29/2024
Don't Forget to Take Questionnaire #3!	...	Don't Forget to Take Questionnaire #3!	0	241	56.43%	19.92%		07/17/2024
Questionnaire #3 and June Events	...	Questionnaire #3 and June Events!	0	225	60.00%	24.89%		06/14/2024
Cheyenne DDA Plan Questionnaire #2 - Provide Your Input by Monday!	...	Cheyenne DDA Questionnaire #2 Closes Sunday!	0	209	55.02%	20.57%		05/03/2024
Cheyenne DDA Plan Questionnaire #2 - There's Still Time!	...	Cheyenne DDA Questionnaire #2!	0	205	57.07%	15.12%		04/18/2024
Cheyenne DDA Plan Open Houses!	...	Cheyenne DDA Questionnaire #2!	0	205	53.66%	0.49%		04/17/2024
Cheyenne DDA Plan Open Houses!	...	Cheyenne DDA April Open House Events	0	197	64.97%	1.02%		03/26/2024
Questionnaire #2 is Live!	...	Questionnaire #2 is Live!	0	158	62.66%	28.48%		02/27/2024

Laybourn: Does the DDA have an email address for all of the property owners that pay the mill levy?

Answer: No, the City does not have email addresses. It is a database we continue to populate. We have done social media posts requesting property owners and businesses provide email addresses. We have received approximately 20 addresses as of those posts.

Laybourn: Questions about Work Plan timeline and snow removal.

Answer: The consultants and staff have not identified a specific date for Work Plan development but anticipate setting that in the near future. This will include items such as snow removal. Snow removal has also been added to the Implementation Matrix on pages 72 and 73.

Emmons: Question about communicating to constituents.

Answer: This was answered verbally at the hearing as falling not the “Public Perception” element of the implementation matrix. This also falls into categories regarding “Website Update” and “Resource Repository” and day-to-day operations in making contact with property owners.

Public Comments:

Astrid: She had general statements about pedestrian counts and not being engaged in the process. She also had concerns with sex offenders downtown.

Answer: Astrid has attended public engagement meetings and spoke directly to Cameron Gloss, Director Bloom, and other staff in length regarding the plan. Regarding pedestrian counts, we have discussed this with the MPO before and have run into conflicts with other travel modes such as bikes and cars that inflate the count. We will continue the discussion with them.

Counts:

According to the below mapping and research tools, a total of 56 sex offenders reside in the Downtown District.

- 19 reside at the County jail at 1901 Thomas Avenue
- 7 reside at the Cheyenne Transitional Center at 322 17th Street
- 25 reside at the Pioneer Hotel at 209 W 17th Street
- 5 reside in individual dwelling units within the district including in upper floor residential that is above shops, like a coffee shop (locations not detailed here).

Map Resources:

Map of distance separation requirements: <https://maps.laramiecounty.com/sor/>

Sex offender location tool (From Laramie County Sheriff's Department Website:

https://www.icrimewatch.net/results.php?AgencyID=55437&RegSubmit=0&AddrStreet=3839+E+Lincolnway&AddrCity=Cheyenne&AddrState=51&AddrZip=82001&AddrZipPlus=82001&radius=2&whichaddr1=home_addr%7Ctemp_addr&whichaddr2=work_addr%7Cvolunteer_addr&whichaddr6=secondary_addr&button=Update (Set the search from the parking garage at 3839 E

Lincolnway and set radius to 2 miles to cover the district. Other results east and west of downtown may appear. Disregard results east of Evans Avenue, west of Snyder Avenue, and north of 24th Street as they are outside the district boundary.)

Glen Garrett: – Questions about what changed as a result of the motion between the public hearing and the DDA Board and PC meetings.

Answer: Please see the attached Summary of Changes where changes are highlighted by orange rectangles.

DDA AND PLANNING COMMISSION DIRECTED CHANGES

The Downtown Development Authority Board and Planning Commission reviewed this item at a joint meeting on January 21, 2025, and recommended approval of the Plan with subject to the following modifications:

1. Add language regarding parking and correct “Walkability from Parking” map.
2. Add language regarding “The Hole” and the importance of its redevelopment to the downtown.
3. Add language regarding administration and the creation of a work plan regarding implementation of Plan goals.

The modifications are highlighted in the attached Summary of Changes with orange rectangles.

The Planning Commission was presented these changes at their February 18, 2025 meeting and the Downtown Development Board at their February 20, 2025 and were accepting of them.

SUBSTITUTE ATTACHMENT:

At PSC it was noted that two added action items, “Continuation of Grant Programs” and Walkability,” these additions propose adding those action items to pages 29, 31, 43, 61, 70, and 71 and are highlighted in the attached Summary of Changes with green rectangles. These were added to the matrix to recognize the existing grant programs and the sidewalk hazard reduction program.

Additionally, several councilmembers requested amendments to the action statements on page 43, specifically to replace references to “metered parking” and incorporate language regarding “parking space delineation.” These changes, highlighted in the attached Summary of Changes by green rectangles, stem from a pending ordinance to repeal the recently approved paid parking districts. The amendments were partly to avoid potential misinterpretations of “metered parking,” which can include various systems, such as individual meters, pay-and-display stations, digital smart meters, app-based zone systems (what was what the recently approved paid parking ordinance aimed to establish), and time-limited zones (the current system in Cheyenne). To further enhance clarity, the “Enhance Downtown Parking” action statement on page 43 was revised to address parking space striping and delineation and recognize potential funding challenges.

Also modified in the substitute is the location and addition of additional web links on the “Links” to be before Appendix 1 and the addition of Appendix 2 (32 pages) which includes all engagement summaries (Phase 1 – 4).

The Planning Commission was informed of these changes at their February 18, 2025, meeting and the Downtown Development Board at their February 20, 2025, and were accepting of the substitute.

ATTACHMENT:

1. Summary of Changes

Goals

1. Improve street and sidewalk infrastructure to enhance pedestrian safety and accessibility.
2. Integrate additional street trees, landscaping, and pedestrian-scaled lighting to create a more inviting and safer public environment.
3. Expand infrastructure for pedestrians and cyclists to support alternative modes of transportation.

ACTIONS

Anchor Tenant. Work with property owners, Cheyenne LEADs, the Chamber of Commerce, and other economic partners to identify an anchor tenant for Downtown or bring in a higher education facility to increase the number of residents Downtown.

Pump House Project. Actively support the completion of the development of the Pump House Project on the five City properties between Ames Avenue, the railroad, and West Lincolnway, including construction of wetlands for storm water detention, and a trail system.

Reed Avenue Corridor. Actively support the finalization and implementation of the Reed Avenue Corridor conceptual design and passenger rail project, and update stakeholders in the DDA.

15th Street Experience. Actively support the finalization and implementation of the 15th Street Plan and implement the 15th Street Experience. DDA staff to update stakeholders.

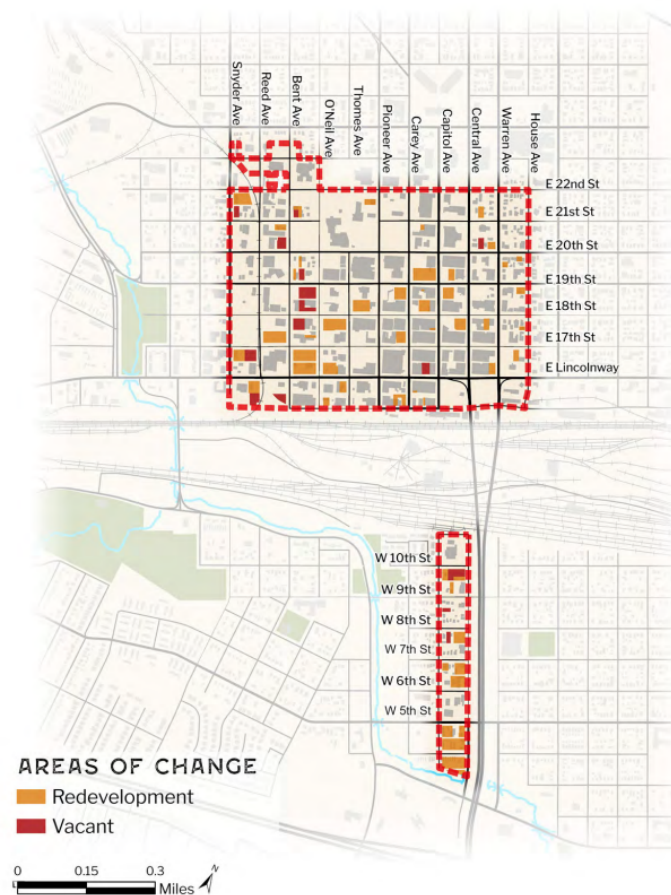
Hynds Building and “The Hole”. Streamline the development process and explore a public-private partnership within legal constraints to restore the historic 1916 Hynds Building and redevelop both the building and the adjacent vacant lot known as “The Hole” for economic development and community revitalization. Support urban renewal efforts, including the use of TIF funding, to aid in the redevelopment of these properties.

REDEVELOPMENT OPPORTUNITIES

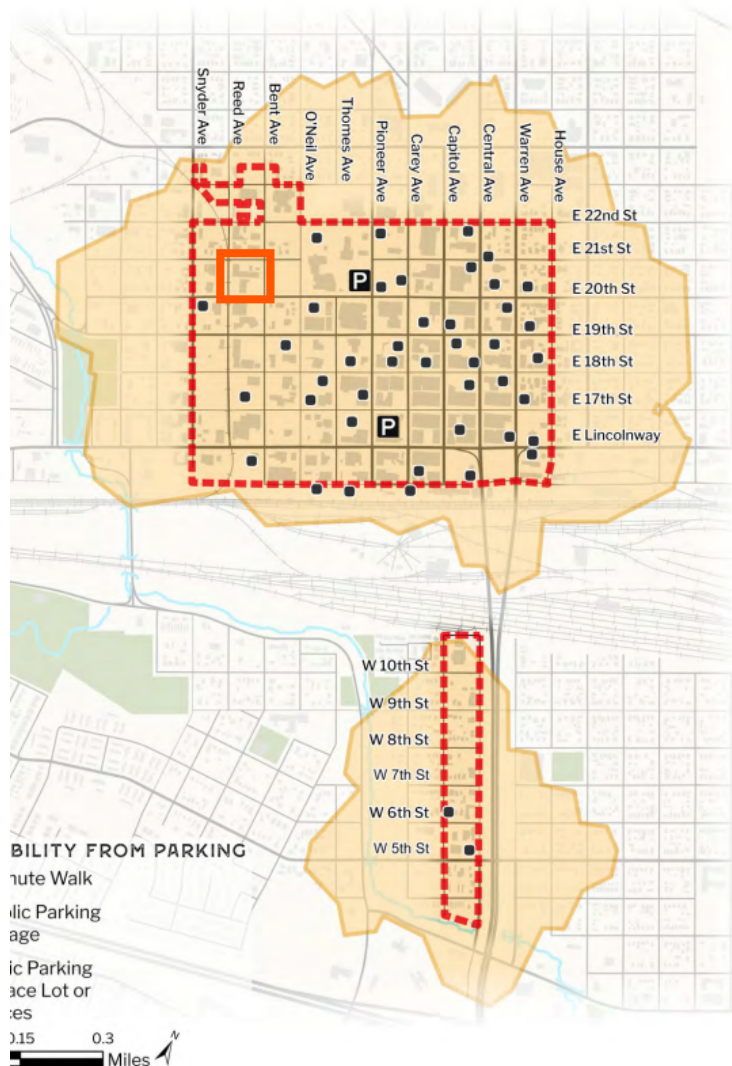
The areas of change analysis identifies where parcels have development or redevelopment potential based on assessors data. It should be noted that assessors data for a property is based on building square footage followed by building condition. “Redevelopment” parcels have relatively low improvement value compared to the land value of the parcel, indicating a strong potential that the parcel can be redeveloped. “Vacant” parcels have no improvement value or are listed as ‘vacant’ within the County Assessor’s records. Redevelopment parcels are common throughout the DDA, and vacant parcels appear frequently west of O’Neil Avenue. A large percentage of parcels within the southern portion of the DDA and along Snyder Avenue are classified as redevelopment parcels, highlighting an opportunity for redevelopment to enhance the character of those areas. While these parcels may be classified as ‘redevelopment’ or ‘vacant’ they may not redevelop for a number of reasons. Outside the DDA’s purview including market forces, property owner desires, or redevelopment costs. This analysis provides a high-level review of potential redevelopment areas, but specific opportunities have not been discussed with property owners.

The above areas of change analysis is based on the entire property, not individual buildings. It has been noted that a number of Downtown buildings have historic second story residential uses, many of which are not currently in use. The Cheyenne Unified Development Code (UDC) does not prohibit the reestablishment of these second story uses, but many property owners have cited high financial costs to rehabilitate the second floors to meet current building code and safety requirements. The DDA is limited in the funding it can provide to assist property owners in second-floor residential use rehabilitation, but there may be state and federal funding sources like Housing and Urban Development (HUD) funds available that could be utilized depending on property condition. There may also be an opportunity to partner with local non-profits to assist with rehabilitation costs.

In 2016 the City completed the *West Edge Area Wide Plan*, building upon the *2014 West Edge Visionary Blueprint*. Part of the West Edge district lies within the DDA district, but the plan extends to the area adjacent to the DDA boundary. This plan identified a number of redevelopment actions to encourage investment in this area, including redevelopment of Civic Commons Park, The Pump House Project, Reed Avenue Corridor, the Steam Plant, and place making tied to the rail corridor. While some of the 2016 Plan has been realized and led to significant reinvestment in the West Edge, completion of remaining redevelopment opportunities is a priority for the DDA.



Page 38, addition of the following language, “**Hynds Building and “The Hole”**”. Streamline the development process and explore a public-private partnership within legal constraints to restore the historic 1916 Hynds Building and redevelop both the building and the adjacent vacant lot known as “The Hole” for economic development and community revitalization. Support urban renewal efforts, including the use of TIF funding, to aid in the redevelopment of these properties.



PARKING AVAILABILITY AND LOCATION

Downtown has two large parking garages with over 1,200 spaces, over 2,300 spaces in off-street parking lots, and over 1,500 on-street parking spaces, totaling over 5,000 parking spaces. By mapping the off-street parking lots and public parking garages and conducting a 5-minute walkability analysis, it is clear that parking lots are dispersed throughout Downtown Cheyenne, making Downtown highly walkable.

Additionally, the 15th Street Plan calls for oversized parking areas throughout Downtown to facilitate tourist bus loading. Residents and visitors have noted that, except during high-traffic times like events and Saturdays, it is generally easy to find parking within a block of their destination. Too much parking can detract from the walkability and aesthetic appeal of Downtown, unconsciously discouraging people to spend time visiting multiple businesses.

In 2016, Cheyenne MPO completed the Cheyenne Municipal Area Parking Study which inventoried parking, as well as assessed the current parking management strategy. Building off this plan, in 2017 the City completed the City of Cheyenne Downtown Strategic Parking Plan which includes a limited parking supply/demand assessment and identifies both short and long-term goals for the development of a forward-thinking and holistically-managed public parking system. Following the direction from these two plans, City Council approved the creation of a paid on-street parking districts program in July 2024. The paid program will be under the City's parking division, as part of the Cheyenne Police Department.

The Downtown Strategic Parking Plan (2017) encourages on-street parking turnover without penalizing infrequent visitors. The parking strategy incentivizes long-term users to utilize the parking garages rather than the on-street parking spaces. The Plan recommends maximizing use of existing on-street spaces and parking garages prior to a 3rd parking garage being considered.

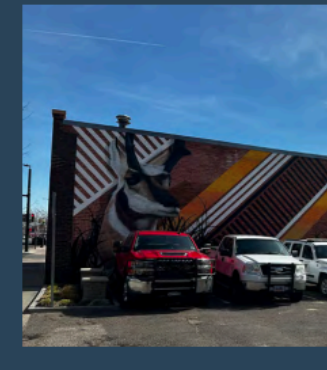
Goals

1. Identify and publicize existing parking locations and resources employees and visitors.
2. Improve utilization of existing parking resources prior to considering investment in new parking supply.
3. Partner with the Clean and Safe Program to change public perception of Downtown parking facilities.

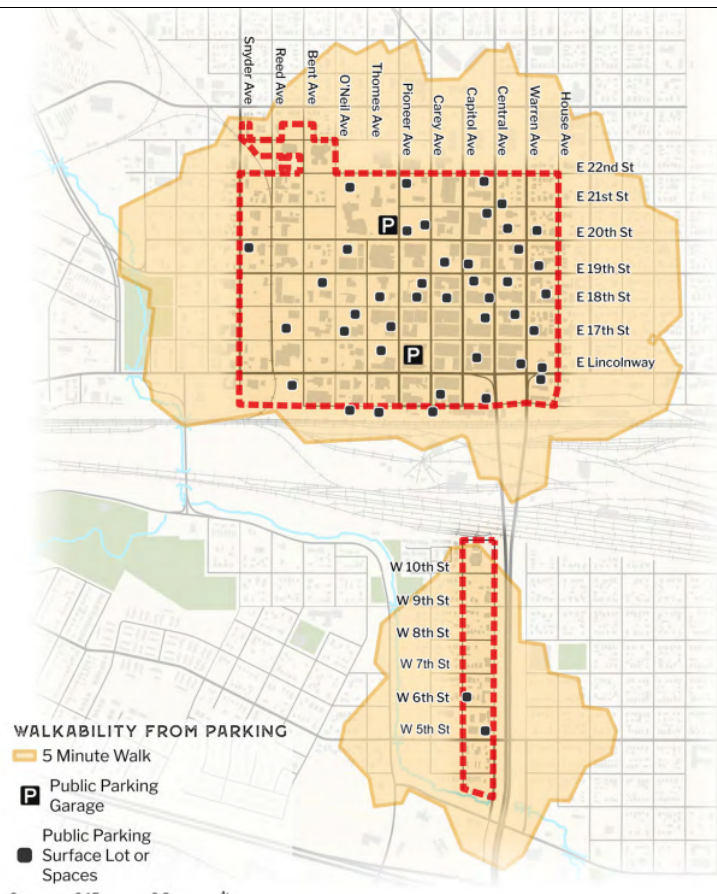
ACTIONS

Enhance Downtown Parking. Support additional areas for diagonal parking located away from high-use pedestrian areas. Stripe on-street parking stalls Downtown. Support the development of metered parking Downtown where appropriate. Work with business and property owners to explore opportunities for public/private partnerships for employee and visitor parking.

Public Perception. Partner to change public perception of Downtown safety and parking availability. Explore the Downtown Ambassador program and partner with the Clean and Safe Program.



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AND LOCATION

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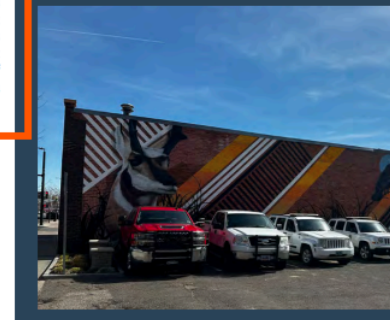
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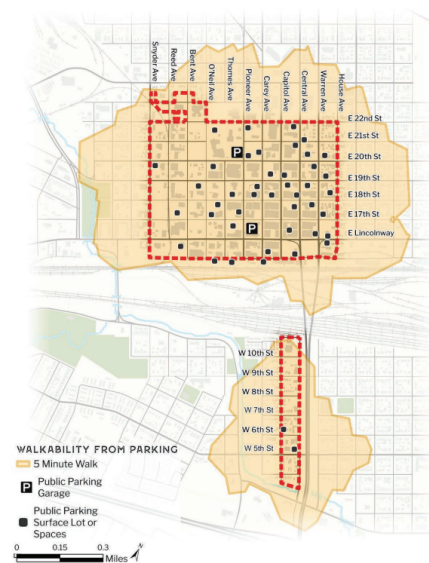
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Public Perception. Partner to change public perception of Downtown safety and parking availability. Explore the Downtown Ambassador program and partner with the Clean and Safe Program.



Page 43, addition of the following language: “The Downtown Strategic Parking Plan (2017) encourages on-street parking turnover without penalizing infrequent visitors. The parking strategy incentivizes long-term users to utilize the parking garages rather than the on-street parking spaces. The Plan recommends maximizing use of existing on-street spaces and parking garages prior to a 3rd parking garage being considered.” Note: A modification has been proposed based on feedback received at the public hearing and Public Services Committee. Seep proposed modification on the next page.



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Goals

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2. Improve utilization of existing parking resources prior to considering investment in new parking supply.
3. Partner with the Clean and Safe Program to change public perception of Downtown parking facilities.

ACTIONS

Enhance Downtown Parking. Support additional areas for diagonal parking located away from high use pedestrian areas. Increase the visibility of parking spaces by striping parking stalls where appropriate and when fiscally feasible. Encourage employees and visitors to utilize existing lots and structured parking in accordance with the Metropolitan Planning Organization's 2017 Downtown Strategic Parking Management Plan. Work with business and property owners to explore opportunities for public/private partnerships for employee and visitor parking.

Public Perception. Partner to change public perception of Downtown safety and parking availability. Explore the Downtown Ambassador program and partner with the Clean and Safe Program.



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Included in substitute: Page 43 (left box), modification of the added language as follows: “In 2016, Cheyenne MPO completed the Cheyenne Municipal Area Parking Study which inventoried parking, as well as assessed the current parking management strategy. Building off this plan, in 2017 the City completed the City of Cheyenne Downtown Strategic Parking Plan which includes a limited parking supply/demand assessment and identifies both short and long-term goals for the development of a forward-thinking and holistically managed public parking system. ~~Following the direction from these two plans, City Council approved the creation of a paid on-street parking districts program in July 2024. The paid program will be under the City’s parking division, as part of the Cheyenne Police Department.~~

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Included in substitute: Page 43 (right box), “Enhance Downtown Parking. Support additional areas for diagonal parking located away from high use pedestrian areas. ~~Stripe on-street parking stalls Downtown.~~ Increase the visibility of parking spaces by striping parking stalls where appropriate and when fiscally feasible. ~~Support the development of metered parking Downtown where appropriate.~~ Encourage employees and visitors to utilize existing lots and structured parking in accordance with the Metropolitan Planning Organization’s 2017 Downtown Strategic Parking Management Plan. Work with business and property owners to explore opportunities for public/private partnerships for employee and visitor parking.”

Action	Chapter	Topic	Priority	Time frame	Category	Lead	Partner(s)	Priority Level
Reed Avenue Corridor. Actively support the finalization and implementation of the Reed Avenue Corridor conceptual design and passenger rail project, and update stakeholders in the DDA.	Infrastructure & Land Use	Redevelopment	Ongoing Efforts	5-7 years	Visionary	Planning, Engineering, MPO	DDA	1
15th Street Experience. Actively support the finalization and implementation of the 15th Street Plan and implement the 15th Street Experience. DDA staff to update stakeholders.	Infrastructure & Land Use	Redevelopment	Ongoing Efforts	3-5 years	Aspirational	Planning, Engineering, MPO	DDA	1
Enhance Pedestrian Crossings. Support the MPO and City Engineering to identify locations and designs for pedestrian enhancements, design pedestrian crossings, and install enhanced pedestrian crossings.	Transportation and Parking	Bicycle and Pedestrian Connections	-	1-3 years	Foundational	Planning	Engineering, MPO, Public Works	1
Greenway Connections. Actively support planning of Downtown connections to the greenway within the Reed Avenue Corridor with new bike facilities on 17 th Street and 22 nd Street, and from the Pump House Project to the Reed Avenue Corridor.	Transportation and Parking	Bicycle and Pedestrian Connections	-	1-3 years	Foundational	Parks and Recreation	Engineering, MPO, Public Works	1
Enhance Downtown Parking. Support additional areas for diagonal parking located away from high use pedestrian areas where appropriate. Stripe on-street parking stalls Downtown. Support the development of metered parking Downtown where appropriate. Work with business and property owners to explore opportunities for public/private partnerships for employee and visitor parking.	Transportation and Parking	Parking Availability and Location	-	1-3 years	Foundational	Engineering	Parking	1
Public Perception. Partner to change public perception of Downtown safety and parking availability. Explore the Downtown Ambassador program and partner with the Clean and Safe Program.	Transportation and Parking	Parking Availability and Location	-	Immediate	Foundational	Parking	DDA	1
Preservation Handbook. Develop a historic preservation handbook outlining grant opportunities, general property maintenance information, and maintenance requirements.	Building & Street Character	Historic Resources	Education	1-3 years	Foundational	HPB	DDA	2
Lighting Design for Alleys. Identify alleyways which need to be lighted and develop an alleyway lighting plan with fixture design, location, etc. Install overhead lighting in alleys per the lighting plan either through an RFP or by City staff.	Building & Street Character	Streetscape Amenities	Safety	1-3 years	Foundational	DDA	Planning, Engineering,	2
Wayfinding Signage. Identify strategic locations for additional kiosks or street signage, and integrated map in the style of existing wayfinding kiosks. Signs could include contents such as written information, a map of Downtown, and a QR code offering users a historic walking tour. Identify and/or enhance digital wayfinding opportunities.	Building & Street Character	Streetscape Amenities	Wayfinding	5-7 years	Visionary	DDA	Planning	2
Entry Surveys. Work with Cheyenne Chamber of Commerce, Cheyenne LEADS, Downtown Business Collective, and other partners to conduct entry surveys of businesses that have relocated to Downtown.	Economic and Cultural Development	Business Retention	-	1-3 years	Foundational	DDA	Visit Cheyenne, Cheyenne Chamber of Commerce, Cheyenne LEADS, Downtown Business Collective	2
Micromobility. Support the designation of specific parking locations for micromobility devices such as electric scooters and bikes throughout Downtown to mitigate impacts to sidewalk congestion.	Transportation and Parking	Transit and Micromobility	-	Immediate	Foundational	Engineering	MPO	2
Explore Local Historic Preservation Funding Options. Work with SHPO, elected officials, and historic preservation specialists to explore additional local funding options for historic preservation efforts tied to affordable housing. Possible options to explore include development of a revolving fund/loan program from the City funding historic remodels for affordable housing, review of State Statutes to determine allowance for local designations for historic affordable housing, and leveraging LIHTC funding for interior residential updates.	Building & Street Character	Historic Resources	Funding	3-5 years	Aspirational	HPB	DDA, Planning	3

Included in substitute: Implementation Matrix page 72, and 73, This reflects the changes made for the action statement on page 43. **“Enhance Downtown Parking.** Support additional areas for diagonal parking located away from high use pedestrian areas. ~~Stripe on-street parking stalls Downtown.~~ Increase the visibility of parking spaces by striping parking stalls where appropriate and when fiscally feasible. Support the development of metered parking Downtown where appropriate. Encourage employees and visitors to utilize existing lots and structured parking in accordance with the Metropolitan Planning Organization’s 2017 Downtown Strategic Parking Management Plan. Work with business and property owners to explore opportunities for public/private partnerships for employee and visitor parking.” Note: this has been relocated to line seven of page two of the implementation matrix for formatting purposes. Implementation items have been slightly reordered throughought but remain unchanged.



DDA OVERVIEW

The Cheyenne Downtown Development Authority (DDA) was established in 1984 and is a affiliated with the City of Cheyenne under W.S. 15-9-201 et. seq. The DDA is comprised of a 7- member, volunteer Board of Directors, appointed by the Mayor of Cheyenne, who is committed to the economic and physical improvement of the Downtown area.

There are two statutorily enabled funding sources for the DDA - tax increment financing and a mill levy. In 1993, a successful mill levy election enabled the DDA to collect property taxes on non-residential Downtown properties to be used for Downtown enhancements. The ultimate goals of this transition were to boost Downtown's profile on the political agenda, encourage investment in Downtown, and redefine the DDA's business recruitment and retention roles.

Today, the DDA serves as the private/public champion encouraging new investment in the central business district. The DDA partners on a wide variety of projects and programs to preserve Cheyenne's colorful history and to enhance historic Downtown Cheyenne, as the region's top commercial center with more than \$100 million in recent and proposed public and private investment.

PLAN OF DEVELOPMENT

An initial action plan drafted for the DDA board in early 1991 recommended the creation of a Downtown master plan. This plan was commissioned by the DDA to develop comprehensive recommendations and guidelines for the development of Downtown Cheyenne. While not the community's first "Downtown plan", the 1991 DDA Plan of Development served as the first statutory guiding document for the DDA under W.S. 15-9-208. Over the years, the 1991 Plan was updated to reflect changing conditions and new economies in Cheyenne, including the 1993 TIF and Streetscape Design Boundary Update, the 2006 Market-Based Plan, and the 2011 Plan of Development.

DDA ROLE

The DDA serves as a key leader in shaping a strong and cohesive identity for Downtown Cheyenne, working toward a future that aligns with its visionary goals. This leadership role involves maintaining a consistent vision, strengthening partnerships, implementing actionable strategies, promoting positive public relations, securing diverse funding sources, advocating for supportive policies and regulations, and engaging with community

service programs that enhance the quality of life in Downtown.

As stated in the 2024 DDA Board Bylaws, the mission of the Cheyenne Downtown Development Authority is to be a catalyst for economic development, redevelopment, and revitalization in Downtown.

To this end, the DDA will:

- Advocate for Downtown welfare, creating and maintaining a positive and constructive image for Downtown among all sectors of the public,
- Support the numerous groups and individuals concerned with economic growth and quality of life, coordinating their efforts relative to Downtown and serving as a liaison between the Downtown community and governmental entities,
- Promote a comprehensive and long-range approach to Downtown issues, framing them within regional and national contexts,
- Foster diversity, good management, excellence in design, and excitement in the mission, and seek funding to accomplish this mission.

PLAN MANAGEMENT AND UPDATE PROCESS

As this plan is used over the next 10 to 15 years, its flexibility should be maintained. No planning document can foresee all possible variations of a community's future, and this document is no exception. The DDA will be called upon to interpret the Plan when its provisions are unclear or when two or more of its recommendations appear to conflict with each other. In these cases, the DDA must act to maintain the integrity of the Plan's vision for Downtown's future.

Monitoring and evaluating the success of activities guided by the Downtown Plan will ensure that the DDA and its partners are on track to achieve the priorities and vision outlined in the Plan. Tracking the status of priorities and action items will evaluate public policy, private investment, and physical improvements throughout Downtown.

Keeping the day-to-day management of Downtown projects within budget and time constraints will rely on creation of a Work Plan. The Work Plan is intended to build upon the guidance provided within the Action Plan and Implementation Matrix and provide a greater degree of specificity by assigning project management responsibilities, assigning project costs and budgets, design and construction scheduling, and project deadlines and milestones. It is anticipated that the Work Plan will be

developed by the DDA staff, with assistance from the DDA Board and community partners, and be updated on an as-needed basis.

DDA staff and the board will review the plan on a regular basis and publish a report that evaluates success and progress made toward priorities and action items. These reviews allow staff and the Board the opportunity to respond to changing conditions and evolving dynamics and implement new strategies as opportunities arise. In addition to annual review, the Plan should be comprehensively reviewed and updated every 5-10 years as necessary.

If staff and the Board find that changing conditions warrant an update to the Plan, specifically updated priorities or action items, DDA staff and the Board may initiate either major or administrative amendments to the Plan. Major amendments are heard and acted upon by the Planning Commission and City Council in accordance with .S. 15-9-208. Administrative amendments are processed by staff with no formal action by the Planning Commission or City Council.

Major amendments have a substantive effect on the priorities and actions in the Plan and warrant public involvement as part of the amendment process. Examples of major amendments are:

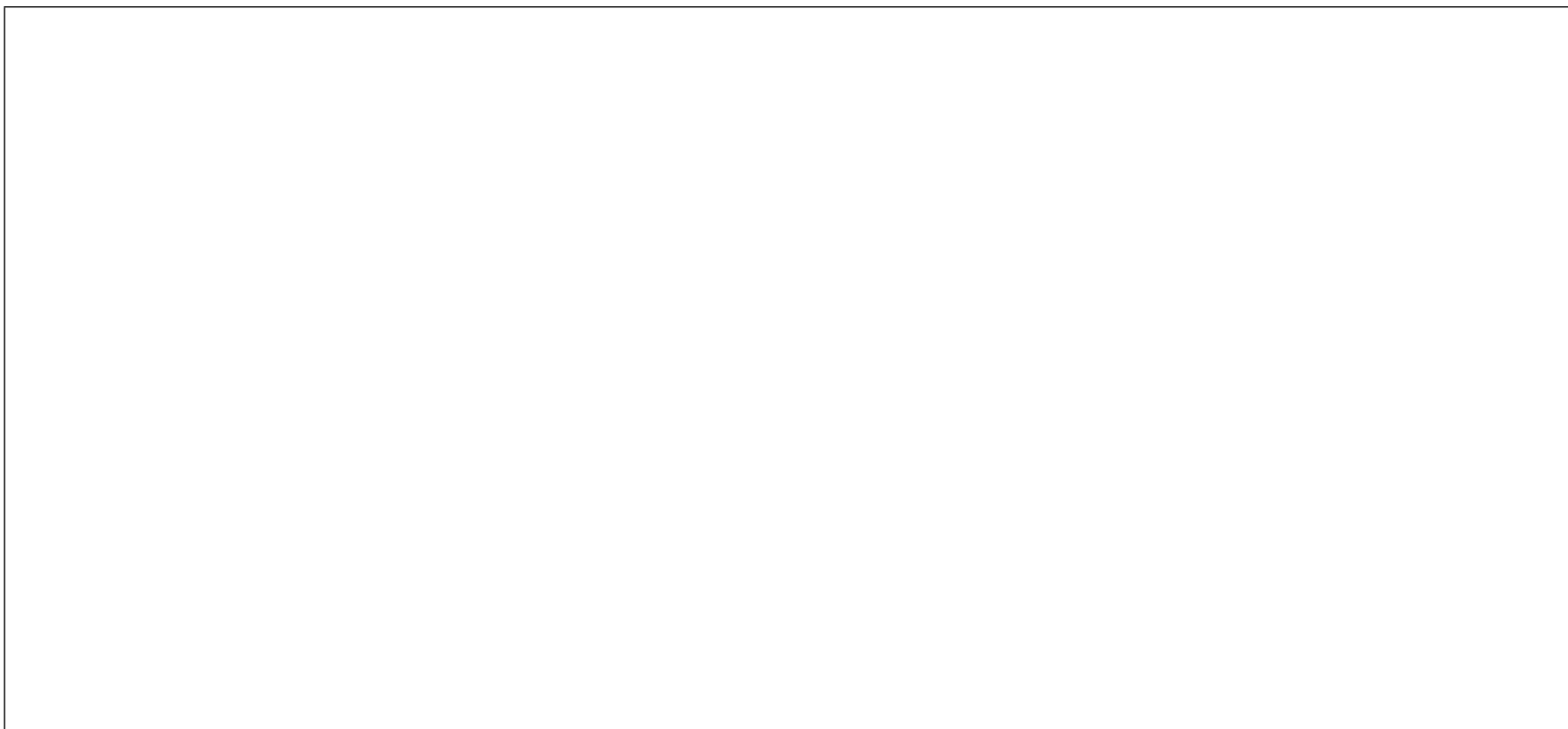
- A comprehensive update of the Plan as conducted approximately every five to ten years.
- Updates to the priorities or implementation action items

Administrative amendments do not affect the priorities and actions in a substantive way. Examples of these are:

- Updates to maps to show an updated DDA Boundary or other informational maps (i.e., roads, streetscape improvements, zoning, historic designations).
- Formatting or graphic updates.
- Incorporation of subarea plans within the DDA Boundary.
- Typographical errors and omissions.

Open communication and regular discussions with residents, developers, business owners, community partners, the Board, and staff are essential to ensure the Plan's action items, projects, and priorities meet the community's needs. The DDA will celebrate progress through social media blasts, updates to the DDA website, cross promoting events with community partners, and email notifications. Broader public outreach may be required for larger action items.

Page 51, addition of the following language: "Keeping the day-to-day management of Downtown projects within budget and time constraints will rely on creation of a Work Plan. The Work Plan is intended to build upon the guidance provided within the Action Plan and Implementation Matrix and provide a greater degree of specificity by assigning project management responsibilities, assigning project costs and budgets, design and construction scheduling, and project deadlines and milestones. It is anticipated that the Work Plan will be developed by the DDA staff, with assistance from the DDA Board and community partners, and be updated on an as needed basis."



LINKS

Business Ready Community Grant and Loan Program: <https://wyomingbusiness.org/communities/financing/business-ready-community/>

City of Cheyenne - Reed Avenue Corridor Project: <https://www.cheyennecity.org/Your-Government/Departments/City-Engineer/Reed-Avenue-Corridor-Project>

City of Cheyenne - Urban Renewal: <https://www.cheyennecity.org/Your-Government/Departments/Planning-and-Development-Department/Urban-Renewal>

City of Cheyenne: Historic Pumphouse: <https://www.cheyennecity.org/Your-Government/Departments/Public-Works/Historic-Pumphouse>

Department of Energy PACE website: <https://www.energy.gov/scep/sisc/property-assessed-clean-energy-programs>

EPA Brownfields: <https://www.epa.gov/brownfields>

FHWA Transportation Alternatives: https://www.fhwa.dot.gov/environment/transportation_alternatives/

NPS Historic Preservation Tax Incentives: <https://www.nps.gov/subjects/taxincentives/index.htm>

US DOT Safe Streets and Roads for All Program: <https://www.transportation.gov/grants/SS4A>

2017 Downtown Alley Enhancement Feasibility Study: <https://www.cheyennecity.org/files/sharedassets/public/v1/departments/planningdevelopment/2017-downtown-alley-enhancements.pdf>

2023 15th Street Corridor Urban Renewal Plan: <https://www.cheyennecity.org/Your-Government/Departments/Planning-and-Development-Department/East-15th-Street>



To be included in substitute: Page 68, the “Links” page was moved from page 74 to 68 (Before the Implementation Matrix, Appendix 1) and subsequent pages were renumbered accordingly.

Action	Chapter	Topic	Priority	Time frame	Category	Lead	Partner(s)	Priority Level
Website Updates. Develop a subpage on the DDA website to share the existing design guidelines and grant opportunities.	Building & Street Character	Historic Resources	Education	Immediate	Foundational	DDA	Planning	1
Funding Guide. Develop an informational guide to federal, state, and local funding opportunities for historic preservation.	Building & Street Character	Historic Resources	Education/Funding	1-3 years	Foundational	HPB	DDA, Planning	1
Streetscape/Greenscape Enhancements, including planters and street fixtures. Locate and assess all needed streetscape enhancements (ownership, condition, etc.), identify a plan (CDs) utilizing the streetscape design manual to define type, size, location, etc. for additional street trees, plants, and fixtures, and define maintenance plan for all vegetative enhancements (staffing needs, equipment, and watering).	Building & Street Character	Streetscape Amenities	Visual/Aesthetic Enhancements	1-3 years	Foundational	DDA	GIS Cooperative	1
Alley Maintenance. Locate and map all alleyways, identifying condition, level of use, and nearby destinations, prioritize alleys for routine cleaning/maintenance, and define maintenance plan for alleys (staffing needs, equipment, capital improvements like cleaning equipment).	Building & Street Character	Streetscape Amenities	Visual/Aesthetic Enhancements	Immediate	Foundational	DDA	Clean and Safe	1
1600 Alley Enhancements. Update the east-west alleys in the 1600 block from Warren Avenue to the parking garage including lighting, utilities, and clean-up. Refer to the Core Plan for alley improvement design. Consult with community partners and utility companies to assess undergrounding overhead lines.	Building & Street Character	Streetscape Amenities	Visual/Aesthetic Enhancements	3-5 years	Aspirational	DDA	Clean and Safe, Engineering	1
Walkability. Evaluate and implement strategies or programs to enhance public safety and pedestrian connectivity through sidewalk repair assistance programs, considering factors such as community needs, funding availability, and program effectiveness.	Building & Street Character	Streetscape Amenities	Safety	Immediate	Foundational	DDA, Engineering	City	1
Enhance Bicycle and Pedestrian Amenities. Locate through GIS and assess all bike racks and sidewalk conditions (ownership, condition, etc.), identify plans (CDs) for additional enhancements and repair of broken sidewalks, trip hazards, and missing sidewalks (define type of pavement, location, block-by-block or whole corridor improvement, etc.) utilizing streetscape design manual. Once installed, define a maintenance plan for facilities (staffing needs, equipment, capital improvements).	Building & Street Character	Streetscape Amenities	Safety	1-3 years	Foundational	DDA	GIS Cooperative, Planning, MPO	1
Existing Street Lighting. Enhance downlighting Downtown by upgrading existing fixtures along 15 th Street, locating additional fixtures to enhance safety, implementing ornamental lighting, and continuing overhead 17 th Street lighting.	Building & Street Character	Streetscape Amenities	Safety	1-3 years	Foundational	DDA	Planning	1
Continuation of Grant Programs. Administer grant programs that encourage private investment, facilitate redevelopment, and preserve the historical character and scale of downtown, while considering community needs, funding availability, and program effectiveness.	Economic and Cultural Development	Tourism, Art, and Cultural Amenities	Ongoing Efforts	Immediate	Foundational	DDA	Planning	1
Resource Repository. Work with Visit Cheyenne, Cheyenne Chamber of Commerce, Cheyenne LEADS, Downtown Business Collective, and other partners to create single location for resources/information related to Downtown events.	Economic and Cultural Development	Tourism, Art, and Cultural Amenities	Events	Immediate	Foundational	DDA	Visit Cheyenne, Cheyenne Chamber of Commerce, Cheyenne LEADS, Downtown Business Collective	1
Winter Events. Continue to work with Cheyenne Chamber of Commerce, Cheyenne LEADS, Visit Cheyenne, Downtown Business Collective, and other partners to identify opportunities for fall and winter events to encourage year-round visitation Downtown.	Economic and Cultural Development	Tourism, Art, and Cultural Amenities	Events	Immediate	Foundational	DDA	Visit Cheyenne, Cheyenne Chamber of Commerce, Cheyenne LEADS, Downtown Business Collective	1

To be included in substitute: Page 71 and 72, addition of two implementation matrix items, “**Walkability.** Evaluate and implement strategies or programs to enhance public safety and pedestrian connectivity through sidewalk repair assistance programs, considering factors such as community needs, funding availability, and program effectiveness.” and “**Continuation of Grant Programs.** Administer grant programs that encourage private investment, facilitate redevelopment, and preserve the historical character and scale of downtown, while considering community needs, funding availability, and program effectiveness.” to recognize existing grant programs and the present sidewalk repair/replacement assistance program. These are both listed as immediate priority 1 items since they are ongoing.

STREETSCAPE AMENITIES

Downtown Cheyenne's initial DDA improvement efforts that began in the early 1990's focused largely on improvements to the streetscape. This first phase of improvements included the repair or replacement of old-fashioned street lampposts throughout the Downtown core, installation of trash receptacles and street furniture, such as benches, and the planting of street trees within grates. Both the tree planting and planter installations have carried through to today and implemented through the City of Cheyenne's Urban Forestry Division Downtown Tree Management Program and the DDA's flower planter program. Over time, street bulbouts and disabled ramp accesses were constructed along major pedestrian routes, that effectively reduce the pedestrian crossing distance and result in lower vehicle speeds. The most significant individual streetscape amenity was the Depot Plaza constructed in conjunction with Cheyenne Depot restoration project in 2001-2006. Overhead festival lighting installed along 17th Street, between Carey Avenue and Thomas Avenue has been a popular enhancement. Lighting along 17th Street was upgraded and expanded in 2023.

Building on the 1998 *Downtown Design Guidelines* (amended 2007), in 2013 the City adopted the *Cheyenne Area Street Enhancement Toolbox*. The toolbox defines the principles behind streetscape elements and the rules for successful implementation. Guidance is provided for the design of sidewalks, curb extensions, street trees and landscaping, seating areas, trash receptacles, screening, café spaces, special event spaces, alley and 'infill' spaces, lighting, and placement of public art.

Planter boxes, when properly scaled, located and oriented, are a simple, effective means of introducing color and visual interest to the street and building fronts. At the

ground level, the boxes can help to define the perimeter of spaces such as an outdoor seating area or provide a visual emphasis at the building entry.

Open air outdoor seating is encouraged Downtown. All seating area elements should be designed to accommodate Cheyenne's high wind speeds, and sometimes harsh snow and sun impacts. Canopies, either permanent or retractable, serve to provide shade, to visually set off the outdoor area as a special place and to add color and visual interest to the building front. Wind break devices should be incorporated along the sides and front to protect patrons. Use of space heaters allows an extension of the areas use in cooler months.

Future streetscape improvements should build upon these successful past efforts. The fundamental improvements start with the repair and replacement of degraded curb, gutter and sidewalk sections that provide a safety hazard. Replaced sections will be constructed based upon a unified design that meets adopted streetscape standards and provides a consistent design treatment throughout Downtown. To the maximum extent possible, sidewalk improvements will be constructed in conjunction with associated capital projects within the Downtown area as a way to reduce construction costs and adverse impacts to the business community during the construction period. A better coordinated, sustainable program for the existing landscape planters must be established that oversees the planter placement, flower planting, and the maintenance and watering schedules, so that the DDA's existing investments can be leveraged and maintenance roles and responsibilities clearly defined. Similarly, Downtown blocks with insufficient or damaged street trees will be replaced through the Downtown Tree Management Program.

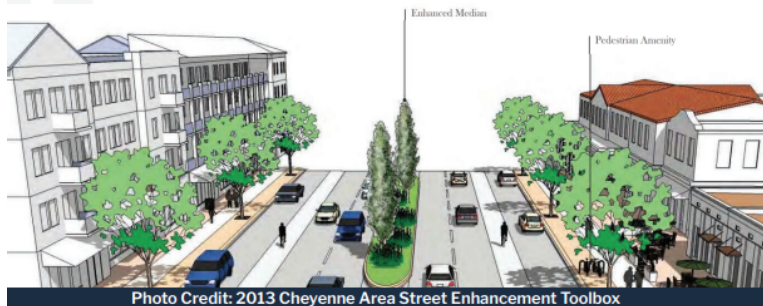


Photo Credit: 2013 Cheyenne Area Street Enhancement Toolbox

Goals

1. **Improve street and sidewalk infrastructure to enhance pedestrian safety and accessibility.**
2. **Integrate additional street trees, landscaping, benches, and pedestrian-scaled lighting to create a more inviting and safer public environment.**
3. **Expand infrastructure for pedestrians and cyclists to support alternative modes of transportation.**

ACTIONS

Streetscape/Greenscape Enhancements, including planters and street fixtures. Locate and assess all needed streetscape enhancements (ownership, condition, etc.), identify a plan (CDs) utilizing the streetscape design manual to define type, size, location, etc. for additional street trees, plants, and fixtures, and define maintenance plan for all vegetative enhancements (staffing needs, equipment, and watering).

Enhance Bicycle and Pedestrian Amenities. Locate through GIS and assess all bike racks and sidewalk conditions (ownership, condition, etc.), identify plans (CDs) for additional enhancements and repair of broken sidewalks, trip hazards, and missing sidewalks (define type of pavement, location, block-by-block or whole corridor improvement, etc.) utilizing streetscape design manual. Once installed, define a maintenance plan for facilities (staffing needs, equipment, capital improvements).

Alley Maintenance. Locate and map all alleys, identifying condition, level of use, and nearby destinations, prioritize alleys for routine cleaning/maintenance, and define maintenance plan for alleys (staffing needs, equipment, capital improvements like cleaning equipment).

Walkability. Evaluate and implement strategies or programs to enhance public safety and pedestrian connectivity through sidewalk repair assistance programs, considering factors such as community needs, funding availability, and program effectiveness.



1600 Alley Project. Update the east-west alleys in the 1600 block from Warren Avenue to the parking garage including lighting, utilities, and clean-up. Refer to the Core Plan for alley improvement design. Consult with community partners and utility companies to assess undergrounding overhead lines.

Existing Street Lighting. Enhance downlighting Downtown by upgrading existing fixtures along 15th St, locating additional fixtures to enhance safety, implementing ornamental lighting, and continuing overhead 17th St lighting.

Lighting Design for Alleys. Identify alleyways which need to be lighted and develop an alleyway lighting plan with fixture design, location, etc. Install overhead lighting in alleys per the lighting plan either through an RFP or by City staff.

Sidewalk Snow Removal. Prioritize walkability following major snow events and partner to encourage the enforcement of snow removal and de-icing following major winter storm events. Explore opportunities for access to group rates with a contractor.

Wayfinding Signage. Identify strategic locations for additional kiosks or street signage, and integrated map in the style of existing wayfinding kiosks. Signs could include content such as written information, a map of Downtown, and a QR code offering users a historic walking tour. Identify and/or enhance digital wayfinding opportunities.

To be included in substitute: Page 29, the action statement for “Walkability,” which was added to the Implementation Matrix, has been added here. It reads as follows, **“Walkability.** Evaluate and implement strategies or programs to enhance public safety and pedestrian connectivity through sidewalk repair assistance programs, considering factors such as community needs, funding availability, and program effectiveness.”



ECONOMIC AND CULTURAL DEVELOPMENT

Businesses are the economic driver of Downtown Cheyenne. Downtown events regularly draw both residents and visitors to Downtown, generating much of the area's economic activity.

The Downtown's economic success will largely be hinged upon the ability of the DDA to support multiple private and public sector partners as TIF funding is sufficiently less than the total investments needed to support Downtown.

Most of DDA's efforts will focus on financially supporting improvements to public spaces and teaming with the City of Cheyenne to implement the new parking strategy, and support the Clean and Safe Program, and the existing snow removal and street tree maintenance programs. Direct investment will largely occur through the façade and property capital investment programs, and streetscape enhancements such as the planter program, street tree planting and curb, gutter and sidewalk replacement.

This plan also encourages more housing units Downtown as part of the overall economic strategy. More housing equates to additional customers to patronize Downtown businesses, an increase in pedestrian activity and greater overall vitality. Housing will largely be accommodated through the conversion of upper building stories to residential units and new infill housing within mixed-use or stand alone attached units.

Cheyenne's strong artistic presence is reflected in the numerous public art installations Downtown, from bronzes and murals to wayfinding maps and performing arts. In addition to local events, the art installations and murals are often cited as a favorite aspect of Downtown for residents and visitors. Previous planning efforts have sought to build upon successful art and entertainment opportunities to encourage emerging and targeted business types such as tech startups, maker spaces,



66% OF SURVEY RESPONDENTS VISIT DOWNTOWN FOR SPECIAL EVENTS, CONCERTS, AND FESTIVALS.

and creative industries. These types of businesses drive innovation and creativity, attracting more people to Downtown and spurring further development and investment in the area.

A number of funding mechanisms are available to the DDA to utilize to spur reinvestment, business retention, and economic development. Each funding option has benefits and drawbacks that should be carefully considered for Downtown investments. Local, state, and federal funding options most applicable to Downtown Cheyenne are described in more detail on pages 62-67 of this Plan.



I MAINLY ATTEND THE BREW FEST AND CONCERTS AT THE PLAZA. AS WELL AS OTHER EVENTS DURING THE SUMMER THAT [PIQUE] MY INTEREST.
-Questionnaire Respondent

Goals

1. Encourage businesses to capitalize on increased pedestrian traffic and visitation tied to Downtown events.
2. Support arts, culture, and creative enterprises by expanding facilities, enhancing promotion, and funding.
3. Leverage Tax Increment Financing to spur private sector investment.

ACTIONS

Continuation of Grant Programs. Administer grant programs that encourage private investment, facilitate redevelopment, and preserve the historical character and scale of downtown, while considering community needs, funding availability, and program effectiveness.

Resource Repository. Work with Visit Cheyenne, Cheyenne Chamber of Commerce, Cheyenne LEADS, Downtown Business Collective, and other partners to create single location for resources/information related to downtown events.

Winter Events. Continue to work with Cheyenne Chamber of Commerce, Cheyenne LEADS, Visit Cheyenne, Downtown Business Collective, and other partners to identify opportunities for fall and winter events to encourage year-round visitation Downtown.

Art Planning. Work with local artists and the Cheyenne Arts Council to create a standard Downtown Art Plan that encompasses murals, statutes, street art, and other forms of art. This plan should create a cohesive vision for Downtown, building upon past successes.

Artist/Makers-Space. Continue to support Arts Cheyenne and local artists in artist maker-spaces Downtown.

Entry Surveys. Work with Cheyenne Chamber of Commerce, Cheyenne LEADS, Downtown Business Collective, and other partners to conduct entry surveys of businesses that have relocated to Downtown.

To be included in substitute: Page 31, the action statement for “Continuation of Grant Programs,” which was added to the Implementation Matrix, has been added here. It reads as follows, **“Continuation of Grant Programs.** Administer grant programs that encourage private investment, facilitate redevelopment, and preserve the historical character and scale of downtown, while considering community needs, funding availability, and program effectiveness.”

ACTION PLAN AND IMPLEMENTATION MATRIX

The Action Plan details steps needed to implement the goals as set forth in Chapter 2. Actions not listed within this document could be identified later and through subsequent public process and still help achieve the goals and objectives within this Plan. This action plan is not an exhaustive list and should be updated as action items are completed in tandem with other Downtown planning efforts.

The matrix in this section represents a list of action items that were identified as community priorities from previous Downtown planning efforts and the public engagement process. The actions contained therein are intended to act as a guide and aide to strategic planning rather than a list of actions and deadlines. The matrix can and should evolve over time and is intended as a tool for plan implementation. The matrix should aide the planning process by identifying strategic partnerships, keeping track of community priorities, and articulating possibilities for plan implementation.

IMPLEMENTATION TIERS

FOUNDATIONAL

Foundational action items are critical early steps in a larger implementation plan that can be achieved within a short time frame, typically 1-3 years, and often at a low cost. These actions focus on health and safety improvements that have an immediate impact, such as maintaining existing infrastructure. For example, safety enhancements may include upgrading existing lighting in public areas, repairing roads or sidewalks, adding crosswalks, or improving signage to reduce accidents and ensure the wellbeing of both residents and visitors.

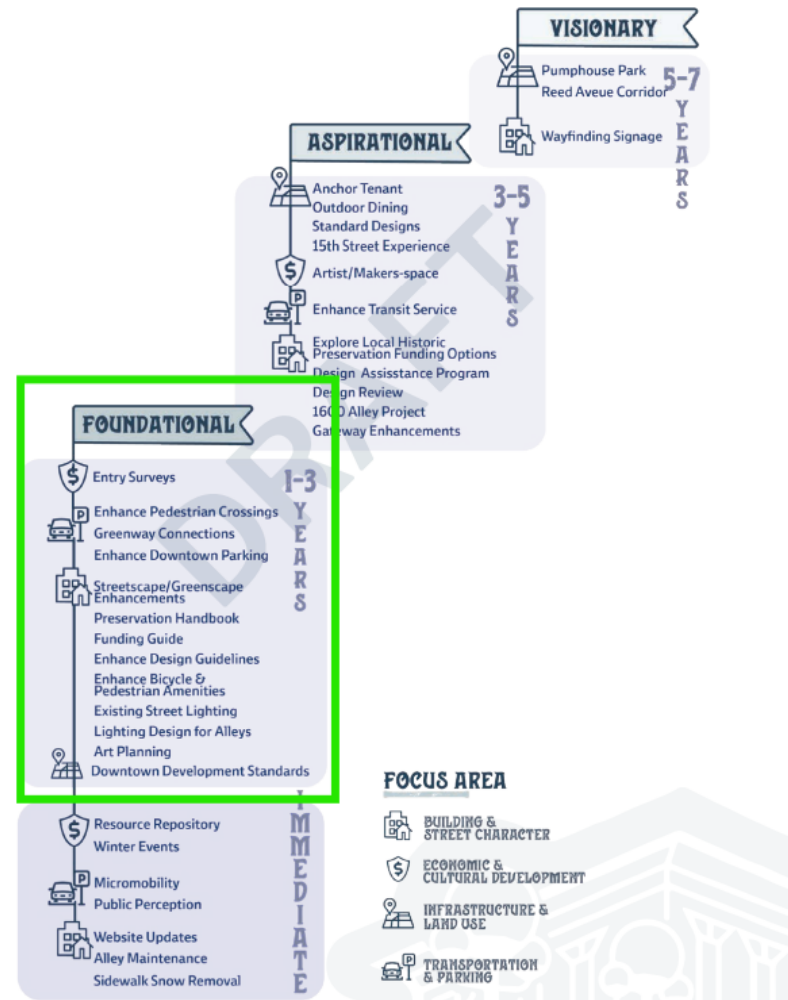
By addressing these smaller, base-level items, Cheyenne is ensuring that the base infrastructure and groundwork have been completed while more extensive future projects are still in early stages. These improvements not only enhance residents' and visitors' quality of life, but also help maintain the long-term integrity of infrastructure, reducing the need for larger and more costly improvements later. By laying the groundwork, Cheyenne can build community trust and demonstrate measurable progress toward their broader goals while managing resources effectively.

ASPIRATIONAL

Aspirational action items are more ambitious projects that require greater financial investment than foundational actions but can typically be completed within 3-5 years. These actions may require greater coordination with external agencies or other City departments and often involve creating new infrastructure or large expansions to existing facilities to enhance community connectivity and aesthetics. Aspirational actions may include expanding streetscape features, such as planting trees, installing public art, upgrading street furniture, and construction of new pedestrian and bicycle pathways. These projects complement existing amenities to enhance functionality and create more enjoyable travel experiences for residents and visitors while supporting long-term goals and priorities of the DDA and partner agencies.

VISIONARY

Visionary action items are long-term, high-cost initiatives designed to transform a community. While these actions are long-term, and require significant coordination and collaboration to achieve, they are vetted by the community and support the overall vision for the future of Downtown. These projects involve large-scale investments that can significantly reshape public spaces, such as the development of new activity centers or the implementation of a conceptual corridor design. These projects rely on foundational and aspirational actions to provide essential services and infrastructure so that visionary projects can stimulate economic growth, enhance social interaction, and strengthen the overall identity of the area. These projects are crucial in ensuring that Downtown is vibrant, inclusive, and forward-thinking.



To be included in substitute: Page 61, this “Walkability” and “Continuation of Grant Programs” action items to “Foundational” category. This modification is the result of adding the new items to the implementation matrix.

APPENDIX 2: PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT SUMMARIES

DRAFT

To be included in substitute: Page 76, Appendix 2 was added. Appendix 2 is 32 pages and includes all engagement summaries (Phase 1 – 4). This can be found on the Plan of Development website on Konveio at www.cheyenneddaplan.com and is included in the proposed Resolution Attachment A substitute.